

Alexandra Barka

SOFTWARE ENGINEER · FRONTEND ENGINEERING · WEB ACCESSIBILITY

Amsterdam, Netherlands

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Building elegant, accessible and user-focused digital products.

Profile

Creative and detail-oriented software engineer with more than ten years of experience building user-focused web products across hospitality, music, streaming, communications and human-computer interaction. Combines deep React, TypeScript and JavaScript expertise with strong product judgement, accessibility practice and an eye for UI quality. Experienced in modernising frontend platforms, improving performance and reliability, mentoring engineers and partnering closely with Product, Design, Backend and QA.

Skills

Frontend	React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, ES6, HTML5, CSS3, CSS-in-JS, Redux, Vue.js, SASS, Tailwind CSS
Quality	Web accessibility (WCAG), design systems, Storybook, Jest, Playwright, UI/UX
APIs & Backend	GraphQL, REST APIs, Node.js, Express, C#, SQL
Engineering	Frontend architecture, performance, observability, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Sentry, New Relic, Coralogix
AI Tools	Claude Code, Cursor, OpenAI
Collaboration	Product engineering, cross-functional delivery, technical leadership, mentoring

Experience

Mews

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Aug. 2024 – Present

- Build, maintain and improve core Groups & Events functionality supporting group bookings, event spaces, quotations and operational workflows. Previously delivered end-to-end Accounts Receivable functionality within the Accounting domain.
- Deliver end-to-end solutions across frontend and backend services, improving reliability and maintainability for high-volume hospitality operations.
- Modernise the legacy Events platform through design-system adoption and redesigned quotation, quote-detail and email-template experiences, with a focus on consistency, accessibility and responsive UX.
- Improve web performance, architecture and technical decisions to reduce technical debt and support long-term scalability.
- Collaborate with Product, Design, Backend, QA and cross-functional engineering teams on PMS integrations, accounting and tax workflows.
- Resolve complex production issues and edge cases, strengthen validation and refactoring patterns, and expand automated unit-test coverage.
- Use AI-assisted engineering tools, including Claude Code, to accelerate implementation, debugging and engineering workflows.

Spotify

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

WEB ENGINEER II

Sep. 2022 – Aug. 2024

- Led development of internal products that empowered marketing teams and drove subscriber growth through high-impact campaign tooling.
- Built and maintained a modern, scalable platform with React, Next.js, GraphQL and TypeScript to meet evolving business needs.
- Spearheaded key projects aligned with company OKRs, ensuring timely delivery and measurable business impact.
- Mentored junior engineers and supported intern onboarding, fostering technical growth within the team.
- Optimised application performance and led technical migrations to modern frameworks and tooling.
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to deliver tailored features that increased productivity and operational efficiency.

WarnerMedia – HBO Max

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Jul. 2021 – Aug. 2022

- Built the HBO Max TV experience, directly shaping the consumer experience of millions of viewers worldwide.
- Collaborated closely with designers and accessibility engineers to adopt a user-centred, web-accessible design system.
- Improved HBO Max TV application performance by 10% by simplifying technical solutions, applying core JavaScript concepts and evaluating trade-offs.
- Wrote and reviewed code, developed technical documentation and debugged problems across complex systems.

MessageBird

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Aug. 2020 – Jul. 2021

- Worked in the onboarding and activation team as a React frontend engineer, balancing fast delivery with product reliability in an agile environment.
- Developed new onboarding and sign-up flows that reduced the time required for customers to connect with their users from days to minutes.
- Integrated the company design system and web-accessibility practices to deliver a consistent and inclusive customer experience.
- Participated in the support-engineer rotation, diagnosing and resolving customer problems with the wider team.

Strangelove Marketing Agency

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Feb. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- Developed modern e-commerce applications and introduced an API-mocking library to accelerate frontend delivery.
- Established unit and behavioural testing tools and automated invoice generation, speeding up the checkout workflow.
- Built a full-stack automated cookie-scanning, monitoring and reporting tool, removing reliance on a third-party service and securing the reporting process.

Yabbu

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Jul. 2019 – Jan. 2020

- Developed a cross-platform remote meeting-management product designed to reduce unnecessary meetings.
- Doubled system performance by applying frontend best practices, simplifying complex code and removing costly libraries.
- Saved approximately 10 team-hours per week by introducing two-week sprint planning, estimation and an organised Kanban workflow; also contributed to CI/CD.

UBITECH Ltd.

Athens, Greece

UI ENGINEER

Jul. 2018 – Jul. 2019

- Created the UX and visual design for a cross-platform application helping organisations such as The Smile of the Child and the Red Cross locate missing children; presented at the European Commission in 2018.
- Facilitated agile delivery in a five-person team building an IoT application that aggregated and visualised daily data streams.
- Co-developed end-to-end Schengen visa services, including a visa-request platform, legal forms and the product landing page.
- Delivered a new UX and UI for MAESTRO for DockerCon 2019 and built risk-matrix and big-data visualisations for predictive maintenance.
- Contributed to form workflows for an aviation data-value-chain platform and transformation of health records into a unified research dataset.

Human Computer Interaction Laboratory - ICS-FORTH

Heraklion, Greece

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER

Jul. 2015 – Jul. 2018

- Designed and developed Ulnify, a real-time studio for composing web-application interfaces in intelligent environments, as part of an MSc thesis.
- Participated with Ulnify at the HCI International 2018 Student Design Competition in Las Vegas.
- Co-developed Beantable, an augmented interactive table with serious games for children, publicly exhibited at Vikelaia Library in 2017.
- Designed and co-developed a cross-platform monastery museum guide released on Google Play and Apple Stores.
- Co-developed an interactive information kiosk showcasing the Minoan civilization and daily life during the Minoan era, publicly exhibited at the Archaeological Museum of Crete (2016).

Education

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

M.Sc. IN COMPUTER ENGINEERING – INFORMATION SYSTEMS AND HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION

Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2018

- Grade: 9.23/10. Major: Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction.
- Thesis: Ulnify: A Designer Studio for Creating UI Mashups for Ambient Intelligence Environments, presented in November 2018 under the supervision of Constantine Stephanidis.
- Teaching Assistant in Data Structures (Panagiota Fatourou) and Modern Topics in Human-Computer Interaction (Constantine Stephanidis).

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

B.Sc. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Sep. 2011 – Feb. 2016

- Grade: 8.19/10. Volunteered as a teaching assistant in Computer Organisation and Introduction to Programming.
- Thesis: requirements analysis and development of a conceptual information-system model for food traceability, supervised by Irene Fundulaki and Dimitrios Plexousakis.